idea of unity in diversity in our national context' (Ministry of Education 2006, p. 1). The National Education Policy 2009 also reemphasized the need to 'promote equity in education with the aim of eliminating social exclusion and promoting national cohesion' (Ministry of Education 2009, p. 19), yet the fundamental core of the education system was still Islam:

> Pakistan is currently engaged in the process of reviewing, updating and reforming school curriculum from Early Childhood Education up to Higher Secondary School levels keeping in view the Islamic teachings and ideology of Pakistan, cultural and religious sensitivities in the country and modern emerging trends to make the whole education purposeful and to create a just civil society that respects diversity of views, beliefs and faiths. (Ministry of Education 2009, p. 32).

This commitment to an Islamic ideology informing the education curriculum while recognizing the importance of respecting 'diversity of views' was also reflected in the Pakistan Studies curriculum under the section titled, the 'role of minorities in Pakistan with specific reference to Quaid-i-Azam's speech of 11 August 1947, defining their status'[5] (Ministry of Education 2006, p. 13). Despite these policy objectives and commitments, the National Commission for Justice and Peace's (NCJP) 2013 study found that hateful and biased material against religious and ethnic minorities had in fact increased in books published after the 2006 and 2009 policy changes (p. 12). Such material was present in textbooks not only for Social Studies and Pakistan Studies but also for Urdu. Examples included statements such as 'Hindus got enraged and started genocide of Muslims' in Grades 9 and 10 Urdu Grammar and Composition textbooks; 'Hindus left the Muslims alone representing their narrow-mindedness' or 'In East Pakistan, education sector was completely under the control of Hindus. They prepared Bengalis against Pakistan and provoked their sentiments' in Grade 10 Pakistan Studies textbook; 'Because Christian rulers were led by fanatic priests; that war with Muslims is necessary for the protection of Cross' in Grade 7 Social Studies textbook; 'Hindus can never become true friends of Muslims' in Grade 5 Social Studies textbook (NCJP 2013, pp. 13, 14, 17, 18). The divisiveness and intolerance promoted through textbooks continues to be a problem irrespective of policy commitments.

Textbooks, Pakistani identity and the Eighteenth Amendment

After the introduction of the Eighteenth Amendment with educational responsibilities devolved to the provinces, provincial governments have taken